

Daily Content Intel

August 19, 2026

Topic A — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, so a new meta-analysis pooled 15 trials and 7,465 football players, and it looked at every hamstring prevention program in the literature, Nordics, sprint exposure, all of it, and the one variable that predicted who got hurt was adherence.

Whether they kept doing it.

Teams at 75% adherence or better cut hamstring injury risk by roughly 64%. Teams under 75% got nothing. Their risk ratio was 0.92, which is basically the same as running no program at all.

And every 10% bump in adherence dropped risk another 17%, so it's kind of a dose response on showing up.

Here's what I do with that. I bury the hamstring work inside the warmup where it can't get skipped, I keep it to 2 movements the athletes can run without a coach standing over them, and I track completion the same way I track weight on the bar.

The certainty rating on this evidence is low, so hold the exact numbers loosely. The principle holds. A program you finish beats a better program you abandon.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: I can tell you by week 3 which teams are going to tear hamstrings, because that's when the prevention program quietly stops.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, so a new meta-analysis pooled 15 trials and 7,465 football players, and it looked at every hamstring prevention program in the literature, Nordics, sprint exposure, all of it, and the one variable that

predicted who got hurt was adherence.

Whether they kept doing it.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 Week 3 is when it dies

- 0:08 15 trials. 7,465 players.
- 0:18 Adherence 75%+ = 64% lower risk
- 0:28 Under 75% = no benefit at all
- 0:38 +10% adherence = 17% lower risk
- 0:50 Put it in the warmup
- 1:05 Track completion like you track load

Caption (copy-paste ready):

A new meta-analysis of 15 trials and 7,465 football players asked which hamstring prevention program works best. The answer was the one athletes actually finish.

Teams hitting 75% adherence or better cut hamstring injury risk by about 64%. Teams under 75% saw a risk ratio of 0.92, which is basically no benefit. Every 10% more adherence bought another 17% off the risk.

Training frequency and weekly volume showed no effect modification. Adherence carried the whole result.

So I stopped shopping for the perfect exercise. I put the hamstring work in the warmup, I keep it to 2 movements they can run themselves, and I track completion like

it's a lift.

Certainty on this evidence is rated low, so hold the numbers loosely. The principle is solid.

It's time to cross your threshold.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT
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#hamstring #footballtraining #lacrosse
#athletictraining #strengthandconditioning
#injuryprevention #returntosport
#highschoolfootball #sportsPT #nova

Personalize this

- Which of your HS football or club lacrosse groups actually held their hamstring work past week 3 last season, and what was different about how that one was delivered?
- You've built position-specific programs for linemen versus skill guys. Where do you physically place the hamstring work in each so it survives a rushed practice day?
- Have you had an athlete re-strain after they quietly stopped their prevention work, and what did that conversation look like

when they came back to you?

Shoot notes:

- Open already mid-thought is what kills these. Start the take with "week 3" already out of your mouth, energy up, chin up, first word landing on frame 1.
- Shoot this one against the plain wall, not the gym windows. The brief flags busy gym backgrounds and big windows as the exact frame viewers bailed on.
- Frame tighter than feels natural, eyes on the top third. The flagged reels all had dead ceiling or wall space stacked above the head.

Hook shape: Story hook: "A story hook is skipped 3.2 points less than your average across 4 reels. It survives the scroll better than anything else you open with." Claim ("that's when the program quietly stops") lands inside the first line, per "Put the payoff in the first line, not after a wind-up."

Screenshots:

- title | <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/41945463/>

| "Intervention components, training dose, and adherence in exercise-based prevention of hamstring strain injury in football: a systematic review and meta-analysis"

- physiology | <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/41945463/> | "High adherence ($\geq 75\%$) was associated with lower HSI risk (RR = 0.36, 95% CI 0.28-0.48), whereas low adherence ($< 75\%$) showed no clear benefit"
- actionable | <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/41945463/> | "Each 10% increase in adherence corresponded to an RR multiplier of 0.83"

Sources:

- <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/41945463/>
- <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC13059038/>

Topic B — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, hot take. The shortcut everybody is shopping for is the thing they already know how to do.

Episode 400 of the Flex Diet Podcast had Dr. Dwayne Jackson on, he's a PhD in neurovascular and exercise physiology, and his line was that there has never actually been an exercise mimetic. Not one.

The peptide crowd is selling MOTS-c and SS-31 as a way to get the mitochondrial adaptations of hard aerobic work without doing the hard aerobic work. Those compounds sit downstream of training. If you aren't pushing the mitochondria in the first place, there's nothing there to amplify.

Now here's the part that matters for a 17 year old lineman. Conditioning is the

rate limiter on strength. When you feel like you're going to throw up between every set, you cut the volume, you cut the intensity, and you cap the entire training block. The ceiling is aerobic.

So build the base. Sled pushes and bike intervals and position specific work, 2 days a week through the offseason, and keep a version of it in season.

I'll hedge the evidence, because the mimetic literature is almost entirely preclinical and the human performance data is thin. I won't hedge the recommendation. Do the work.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: A lineman asked me which supplement would fix his stalled bench, and the honest answer was his conditioning.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, hot take. The shortcut everybody is shopping for is the thing they already know

how to do.

Episode 400 of the Flex Diet Podcast had Dr. Dwayne Jackson on, he's a PhD in neurovascular and exercise physiology, and his line was that there has never actually been an exercise mimetic. Not one.

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I'll hedge the evidence, because the mimetic literature is almost entirely preclinical and the human performance data is thin. I won't hedge the recommendation. Do the work.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 There has never been an exercise mimetic
- 0:12 MOTS-c and SS-31 sit downstream of training
- 0:24 Nothing to amplify if you never trained
- 0:34 Conditioning is the rate limiter on strength
- 0:46 Gassed between sets = capped training block
- 0:58 Sleds, bike intervals, 2x/week offseason
- 1:10 Preclinical evidence. Confident recommendation.

Caption (copy-paste ready):

A lineman asked me which supplement would fix his stalled bench. The answer was

his conditioning.

Flex Diet Podcast ep 400 with Dr. Dwayne Jackson made the point clearly: there has never been an actual exercise mimetic.

MOTS-c and SS-31 are downstream of hard training. If nothing is stressing the mitochondria, there's nothing for a compound to amplify.

For a high school or college athlete the practical version is simpler. Conditioning is the rate limiter on strength. If you're gassed between every set, you cut volume, you cut intensity, and the whole block gets capped.

Sleds, bike intervals, position specific work. 2 days a week in the offseason, a smaller dose in season.

The mimetic literature is almost entirely preclinical and human performance data is thin, so I'm hedging there. I'm not hedging on the training.

It's time to cross your threshold.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT
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#strengthandconditioning #footballtraining
#highschoolfootball #lacrosse
#athleteperformance #peptides #conditioning
#offseasontraining #sportsPT #nova

Personalize this

- Which of your linemen or midfielders had the clearest case of conditioning capping their strength work, and what changed in their numbers once you added the aerobic piece?
- Have athletes or parents brought you peptides, "exercise in a pill" products, or recovery gadgets in the last year, and how do you answer that without being dismissive?
- What does your actual offseason conditioning dose look like for a football lineman versus a club lacrosse midfielder, and how does it map onto the CROSS framework?

Shoot notes:

- This is the higher-energy of the two takes, so let the delivery match it. The brief's drop-off frames all read "flat expression,

low energy" at the exact moment viewers left.

- Stand and use hands, don't sit. The failing frames were static talking-head close-ups against blank wall with dead space above the head.
- Deliver "there has never been an exercise mimetic" as a full sentence on camera, not a clause you walk into. No mid-sentence cold open.

Hook shape: Story hook: same brief line ("A story hook is skipped 3.2 points less than your average across 4 reels"). Opens on a real athlete moment with the claim already resolved in the same sentence, avoiding the flagged "Most people X and wonder why Y" setup pattern.

Screenshots:

- title | <https://miketnelson.com/podcast/mitochondrial-peptides-mots-c-ss-31-dwayne-jackson> | "Build Aerobic Fitness Before Mitochondrial Peptides"
- physiology | <https://miketnelson.com/podcast/mitochondrial-peptides-mots-c-ss-31-dwayne-jackson>

wayne-jackson | "Mitochondrial peptides may be promising, but they cannot replace the aerobic base that makes their effects measurable."

- actionable | <https://miketnelson.com/podcast/mitochondrial-peptides-mots-c-ss-31-dwayne-jackson> | "why fitness data, training, and recovery come before any experimental compound"

Sources:

- <https://miketnelson.com/podcast/mitochondrial-peptides-mots-c-ss-31-dwayne-jackson>
- <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC11944853/>

Reference

Runner-up topics

- Sleep extension to 10 hours in adolescent athletes and the under-8-hours injury risk multiplier, good athlete + parent crossover, needs a fresher primary source than the 2014 dataset everything still cites.
- Air quality and particulate exposure as a training variable for outdoor fall sports, raised in the Flex Diet episode. Timely for August two-a-days, needs a real paper behind it.
- Kidney function, aerobic collapse, and rebuilding capacity after major illness (same episode). Strong human story, wrong lane for the athlete-first feed right now.

Sources scanned today

- Newsletter digest
newsletter_digest_2026-08-19.pdf, 2 sources. Mercola issue was pure promo (supplement dosing teaser, skipped).
Mike T. Nelson's Flex Diet Podcast ep

400 with Dr. Dwayne Jackson (neurovascular + exercise physiology PhD) on mitochondrial peptides, AMPK/mTOR signaling, and conditioning as the rate limiter for strength athletes. Carried into Draft B.

- PubMed, hamstring strain injury prevention, sprint exposure, adherence. Surfaced a new systematic review and meta-analysis (Ann Med, Apr 2026, n = 7,465) on intervention components, training dose, and adherence. Carried into Draft A.
- PubMed / PMC, exercise mimetics evidence base. Pulled the 2025 Nutrients systematic review on exercise mimetics in aging for the human-evidence hedge in Draft B.
- Frontiers in Physiology 2025 lactate clearance review, read, only tangentially supportive of the Draft B mechanism, dropped rather than cited loosely.
- Trends in Endocrinology & Metabolism "Exercise pills for cardiometabolic health cannot mimic the exercise milieu",

cell.com returned HTTP 403,
unreachable, not cited.

- Adolescent sleep / training load sweep, nothing newer than prior coverage worth the slot, held as runner-up.
- Content brief (Social Media/content-brief.md, generated 2026-08-19T05:21Z), fresh, used for both hooks.